



2026 User Manual

Uni Textbook Marketplace

For **Demo 4**
Presented by:



User Manual

Project: Uni Textbook Marketplace
Team: NexusDev
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1. Introduction

The Uni Textbook Marketplace is a university-only marketplace where verified students can buy, sell, and swap textbooks. It offers module-aware browsing, edition-specific listings, and privacy-first in-app messaging to reduce scams and mismatches. Beyond buying and selling, it also offers AI-assisted listing creation from a photo of your book, real-time textbook auctions, and a bundle optimizer that finds the best way to buy all your books for a semester.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Landing Interface

When you first open the Uni Textbook Marketplace, you'll be greeted by a landing page that highlights the platform's core features:

- Buying and selling textbooks
- Verified-student-only access
- In-app messaging

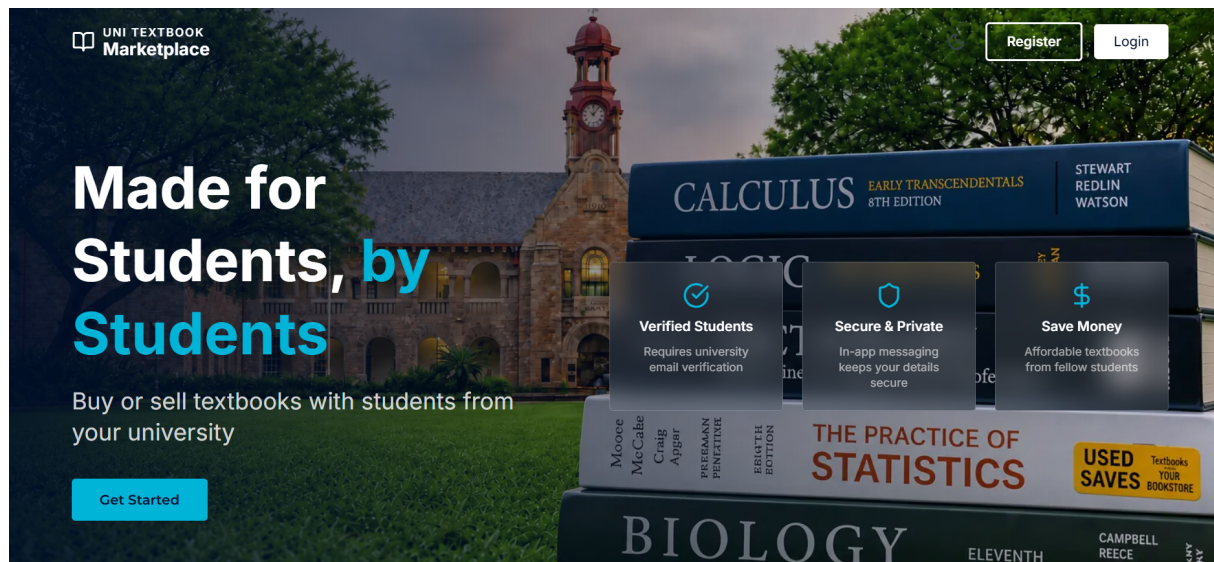


Figure 1: Landing page

2.2 Register Interface

The Uni Textbook Marketplace's registration interface consists of multiple steps for student verification and authentication. Students are verified via their university email; after registering, they receive an OTP code to confirm their identity.

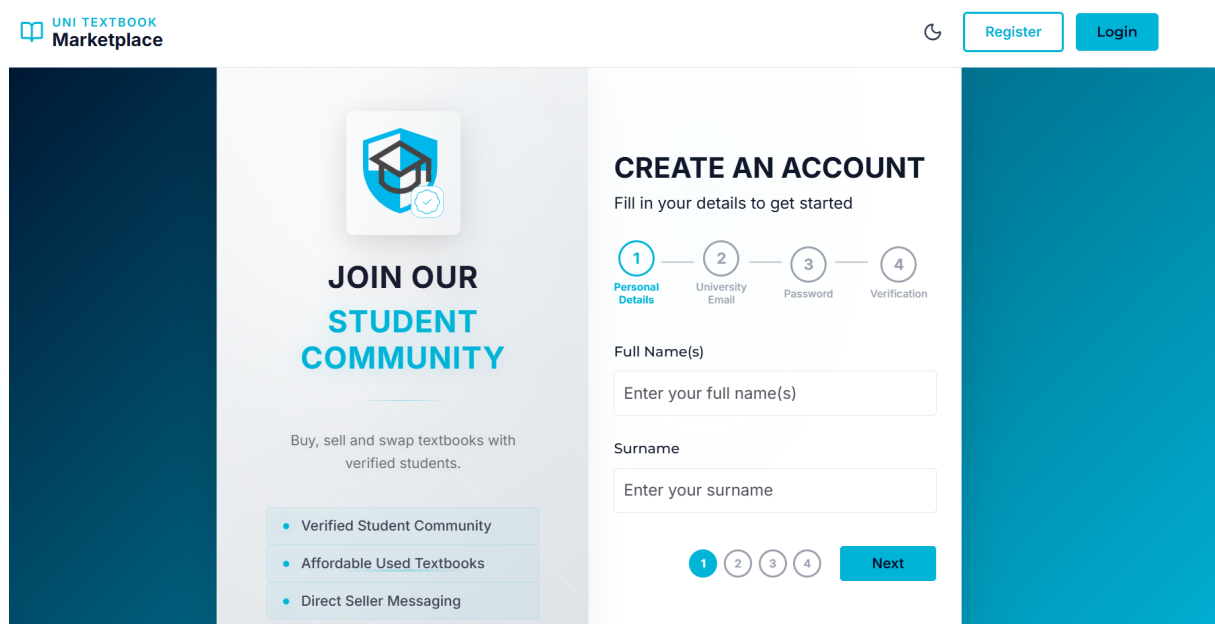
- **Step 1** Personal details
- **Step 2** University details
- **Step 3** Creating Password
- **Step 4** Verification

Supported universities

To register, you must use your official *student* email address from one of the universities below. Staff and alumni addresses are not accepted, and a personal address such as Gmail will not work. If your university is not on the list, you cannot register yet.

University	Student email ends with
University of Pretoria	@tuks.co.za
University of Cape Town	@myuct.ac.za
University of the Witwatersrand	@students.wits.ac.za
University of Johannesburg	@student.uj.ac.za
University of South Africa (Unisa)	@mylife.unisa.ac.za
University of the Western Cape	@myuwc.ac.za
University of KwaZulu-Natal	@stu.ukzn.ac.za

University	Student email ends with
University of the Free State	@ufs4life.ac.za
University of Limpopo	@myturf.ul.ac.za
North-West University	@mynwu.ac.za
Rhodes University	@campus.ru.ac.za
Stellenbosch University	@sun.ac.za
Cape Peninsula University of Technology	@mycput.ac.za
Durban University of Technology	@dut4life.ac.za
Tshwane University of Technology	@tut4life.ac.za



The image shows the 'Register' interface of the Uni Textbook Marketplace. At the top, the logo 'UNI TEXTBOOK Marketplace' is on the left, and 'Register' and 'Login' buttons are on the right. The main content area is split into two columns. The left column features a blue shield icon with a graduation cap and a checkmark, followed by the text 'JOIN OUR STUDENT COMMUNITY'. Below this, it says 'Buy, sell and swap textbooks with verified students.' and lists three benefits: 'Verified Student Community', 'Affordable Used Textbooks', and 'Direct Seller Messaging'. The right column is titled 'CREATE AN ACCOUNT' and says 'Fill in your details to get started'. It shows a four-step progress bar: 1. Personal Details (active), 2. University Email, 3. Password, and 4. Verification. Below the progress bar are two input fields: 'Full Name(s)' with the placeholder 'Enter your full name(s)' and 'Surname' with the placeholder 'Enter your surname'. At the bottom of the right column is a 'Next' button.

Figure 2: Register Interface

2.3 Login Interface

To log in to your existing account, you will need to provide:

- Your email
- Your Password

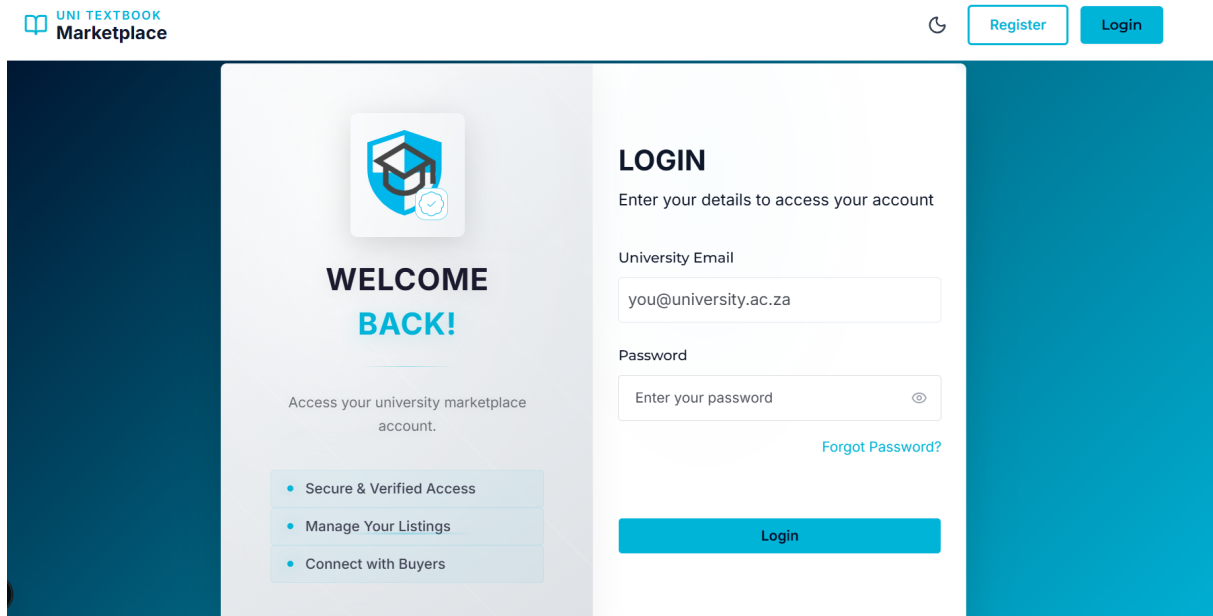


Figure 3: Login Page

2.4 Forgot Password Interface

The Uni Textbook Marketplace provides a password-reset feature for when you forget your password. The Forgot Password page is accessed via a link on the Login page, and the process consists of three steps, including an OTP verification step.

The screenshot displays the 'Uni Textbook Marketplace' user interface. At the top left is the logo, and at the top right are 'Register' and 'Login' buttons. The main content area is split into two panels. The left panel, titled 'SECURE YOUR ACCOUNT', features a shield icon with a graduation cap and a checkmark, followed by the heading 'SECURE YOUR ACCOUNT' and the instruction 'Secure your account by creating a new password.' Below this is a list of three options: 'Reset Your Password', 'Secure Your Account', and 'Regain Access'. The right panel, titled 'RESET PASSWORD', shows a progress bar with three steps: '1 Details' (active), '2 Verification', and '3 Success'. It prompts the user to 'Enter your email and new password' and includes input fields for 'Email', 'Password', and 'Confirm Password', each with a 'Next' button at the bottom.

Figure 4: Forgot Password Page

3. Browse Interface

After logging in or registering, you'll land on the Browse page, where you can view all available textbook listings from other students.

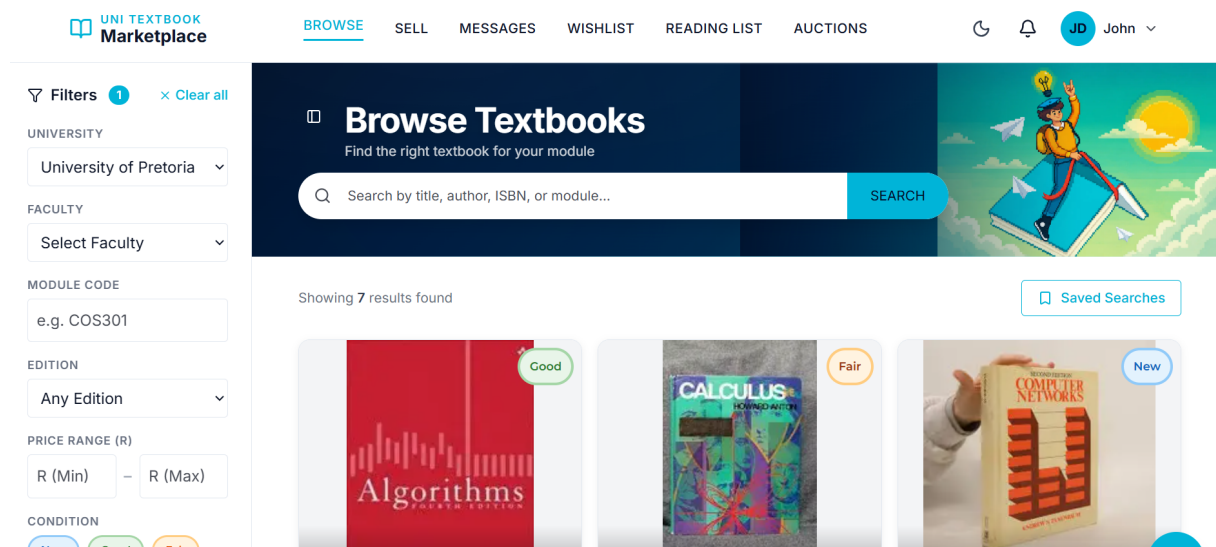


Figure 5: Browse Page

Other features available on the Browse page include **filters**, **search**, **saving a filter**, and **viewing saved filters**.

3.1 Filters and save filters

The Uni Textbook Marketplace lets you filter listings to find the textbook you want. If you don't find what you're looking for right away, you can save the filter and revisit it later by clicking Saved Search. From there, select a saved filter and click Apply to reapply it instantly, without having to re-enter your criteria.

3.2 Search

You can also search for any textbook by name, module, or faculty.

3.3 Saved Searches

Clicking the Saved Search button takes you to a page listing all your saved searches, where you can apply or delete any of them.

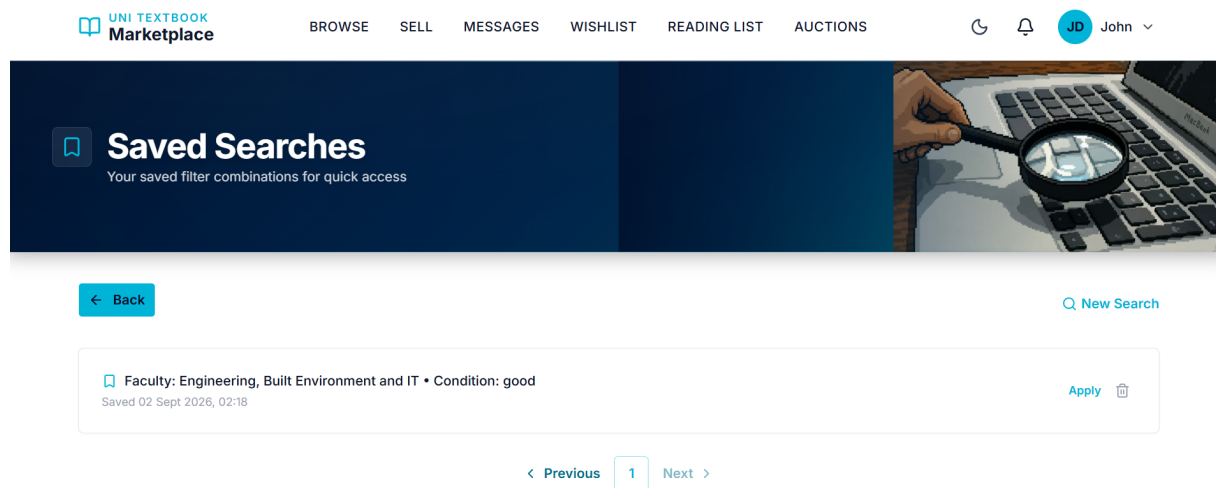


Figure 6: Saved Search

4. Sell Interface

Clicking Sell lets you create a new listing. The process has four steps, and once submitted, your listing will be reviewed by an admin, who can approve or reject it.

- **Step 1** Book details
- **Step 2** Module details
- **Step 3** Listing details
- **Step 4** Upload photos

4.1 Book details

The screenshot shows the 'Book Details' step of a four-step process (Book Details, Module Details, Listing Details, Upload Pictures). The 'Book Details' section includes an AI scanning feature with a 'Take photo' button and a 'Choose from gallery' button. Below this are input fields for 'Name of book *' (containing 'e.g. Software Engineering') and 'Author *' (containing 'D. H. C.').

UNI TEXTBOOK Marketplace

BROWSE **SELL** MESSAGES WISHLIST READING LIST AUCTIONS

Book Details Module Details Listing Details Upload Pictures

Book Details

Scan with AI
Photograph your book's front cover and we'll try to fill in the details. You can still enter everything manually.

[Take photo](#) [Choose from gallery](#)

Name of book *
e.g. Software Engineering

Author *
D. H. C.

Figure 7: Book details

4.2 Module details

The screenshot shows the 'Module Details' form in the Uni Textbook Marketplace. The navigation bar at the top includes 'BROWSE', 'SELL' (highlighted), 'MESSAGES', 'WISHLIST', 'READING LIST', and 'AUCTIONS'. A user profile for 'John' is visible. The progress bar shows four steps: 'Book Details' (completed), 'Module Details' (current), 'Listing Details', and 'Upload Pictures'. The 'Module Details' form contains four required fields: 'Module Code *' (with example 'e.g. COS301'), 'Module Name *' (with example 'e.g. Software Engineering'), 'Semester *' (with example 'e.g. 1 or 2 & 3 for whole year'), and 'Faculty *' (a dropdown menu with 'Select Faculty' as the placeholder).

UNI TEXTBOOK Marketplace

BROWSE SELL MESSAGES WISHLIST READING LIST AUCTIONS

JD John

✓ Book Details Module Details Listing Details Upload Pictures

Module Details

Module Code *

e.g. COS301

Module Name *

e.g. Software Engineering

Semester *

e.g. 1 or 2 & 3 for whole year

Faculty *

Select Faculty

Figure 8: Module Details

4.3 Listing details

The screenshot shows the 'Uni Textbook Marketplace' interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with links: BROWSE, SELL (highlighted), MESSAGES, WISHLIST, READING LIST, and AUCTIONS. On the right, there are icons for a refresh, a bell, and a user profile (JD John). Below the navigation bar is a progress bar with four steps: '✓ Book Details', '✓ Module Details', 'Listing Details' (current step), and 'Upload Pictures'. The 'Listing Details' form contains the following fields:

- Listing title ***: A text input field with the placeholder 'e.g. Title'.
- Condition ***: A dropdown menu with the option 'Select Condition'.
- Annotation Level ***: A dropdown menu with the option 'Select Level'.
- Did you write notes inside ***: A dropdown menu with the option 'No'.

Figure 9: Listing details

4.4 Upload photos

The screenshot shows the 'Upload Pictures' step in a four-step process. The steps are: Book Details, Module Details, Listing Details, and Upload Pictures. The 'Upload Pictures' step is highlighted. It contains a list of requirements: 'Please upload at least 4 clear photos:' followed by a bulleted list: 'Front cover', 'Back cover', 'Side / spine view', and 'Inside pages (showing any annotations)'. Below the list is a large dashed rectangular box with an upload icon and the text 'Click to upload images'.

Figure 10: Upload Photos

4.5 AI-Assisted Listing Creation

You don't have to type everything in yourself. When you take or upload a photo of your textbook, the marketplace can read the text on the cover and match it against the books already in the system. If it finds a match, it fills in the book details for you, so all you need to do is check that they're right and correct anything that isn't. You are always in control: nothing is submitted until you confirm the form yourself.

- **Auto-filled details:** the title, author, and ISBN are filled in from your photo. Check them before continuing, since photos taken at an angle or in poor light can be misread.
- **Cleaner photos:** the app removes the background behind your book and suggests where to crop.
- **Adjust the crop:** four corner handles are placed on the edges of your book. Drag any corner to adjust the crop, and the preview updates as you move it. Confirm when it looks right.

If the AI step doesn't work: if the photo can't be read or the service is slow to respond, the form simply stays empty and you can fill in the details by hand exactly as before. Nothing is blocked.

5. My Listings

The My Listings page shows all the listings you've created, filtered into the following categories:

- All: This is all your listings
- Pending: All your listings that are pending, yet to be reviewed by admin

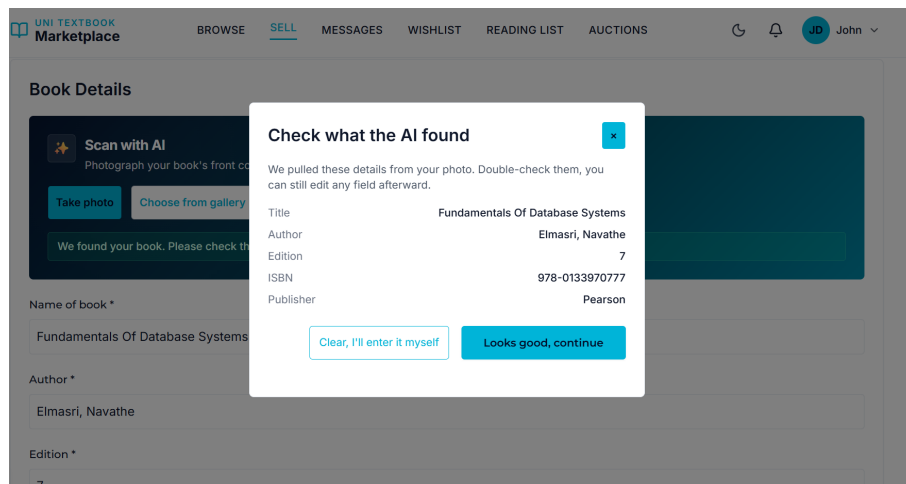


Figure 11: Book details auto-filled from a photo

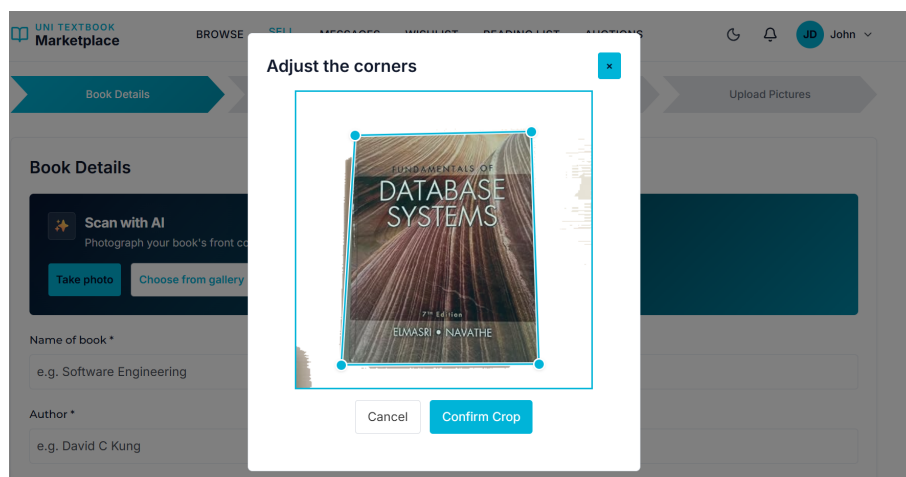


Figure 12: Adjusting the crop with draggable corners

- Rejected: All your listings that have been rejected by admin, due to various reasons

5.1 Editing Listing

Pending and Rejected listings can be edited, allowing you to change the price, title, photos, and more. This is useful if you entered incorrect details or an admin has requested specific changes.

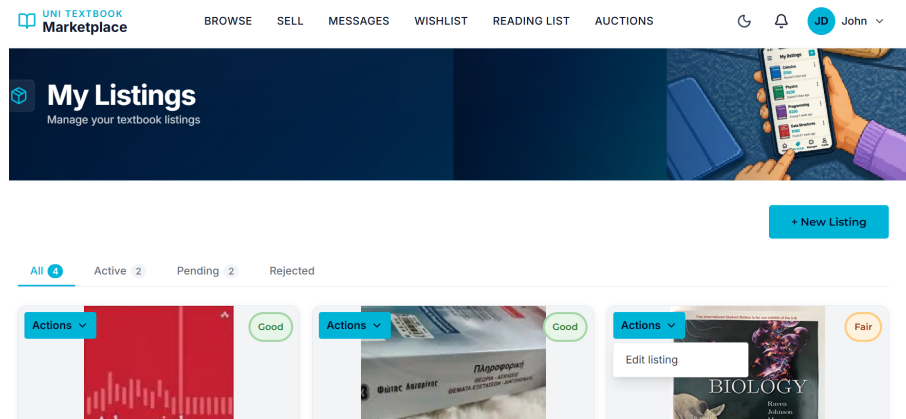


Figure 13: My listing page

5.2 Marking a Listing as Reserved or Sold

Once you've agreed on a sale with a buyer, you can update your listing's status directly from your conversation with that buyer, or from the My Listings page. Mark it as **Reserved** while you arrange the handover, then mark it as **Sold** once the exchange is complete. Both statuses are shown as badges on the listing so other students know it's no longer available.

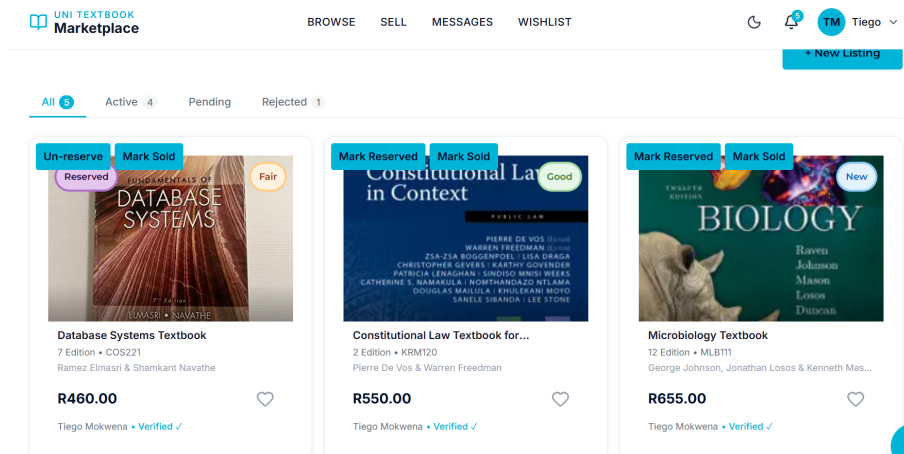


Figure 14: Reserved and Sold status

6. Listing Page

This page displays the full details of a listing, including its module information and book details.

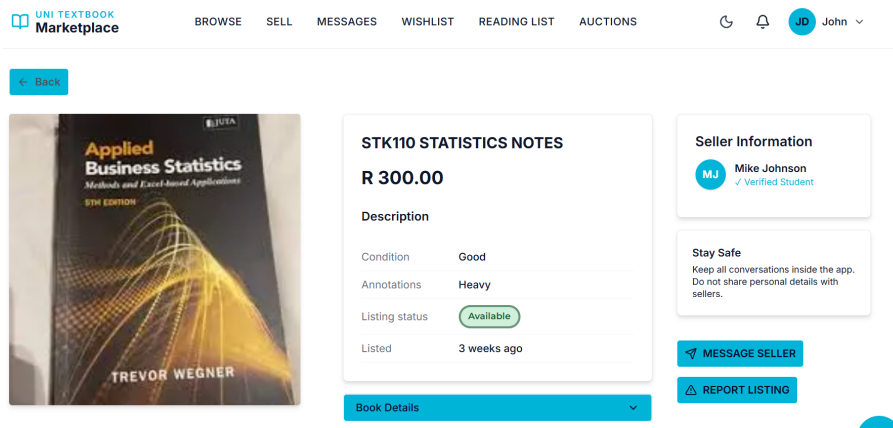


Figure 15: Listing Page

6.1 Reporting a Listing

If a listing looks suspicious or breaks the platform's rules, click Report on the listing page and tell us why. Our admins will review it and take action if needed.

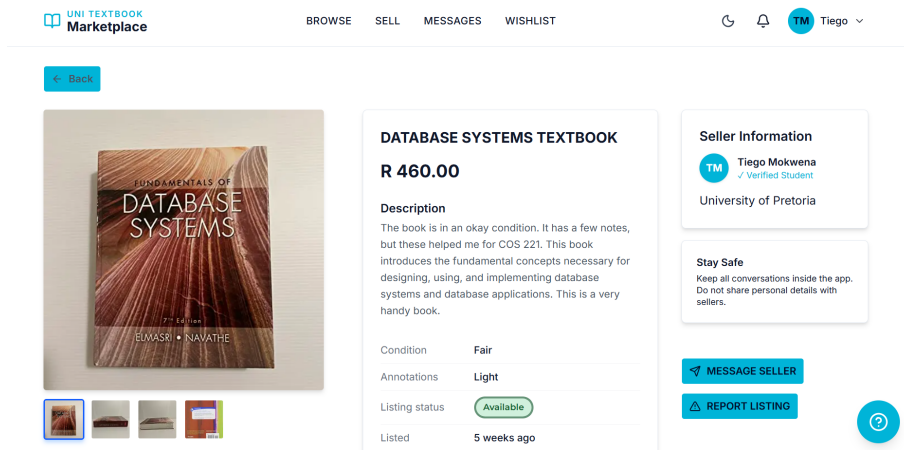


Figure 16: Reporting a listing

7. Messaging

On this page, you can chat with potential buyers or sellers. Conversations are started by clicking the Message button on a listing's page. If you're the seller and you've agreed on a sale within a conversation, you can also mark the listing as Reserved or Sold directly from the thread – see My Listings for details.

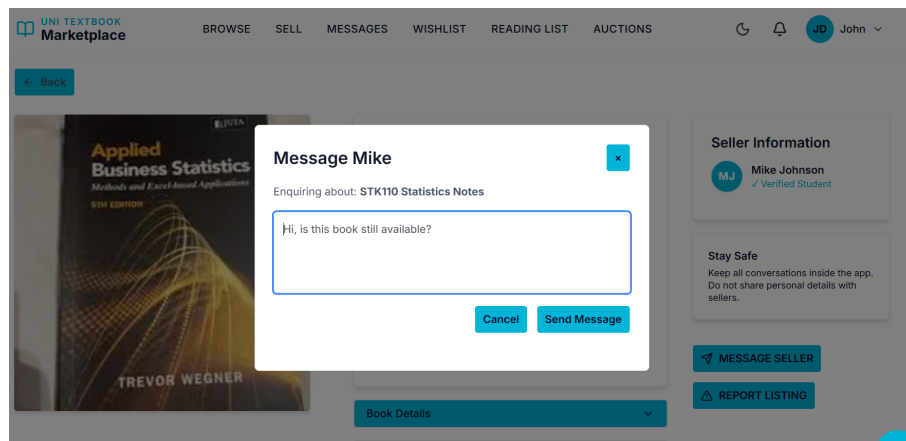


Figure 17: Messaging a Seller

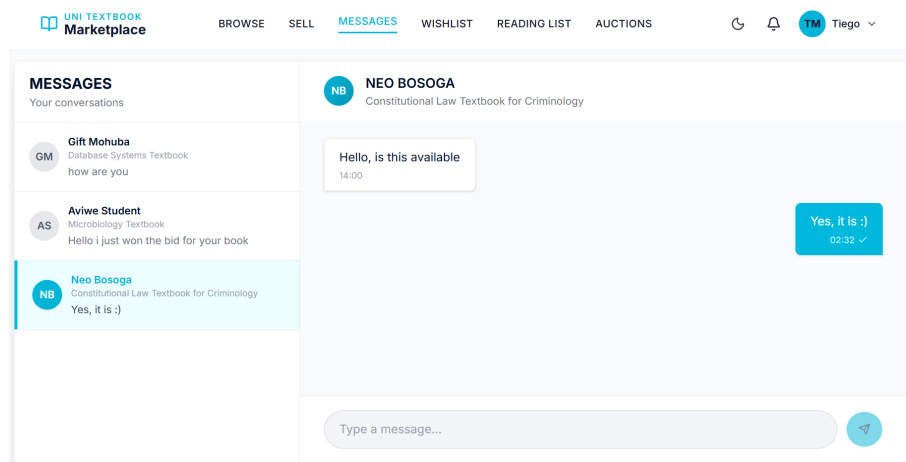


Figure 18: An ongoing conversation

8. Wishlist

On each listing card, click the heart icon to add that listing to your wishlist. Saved listings will appear here.

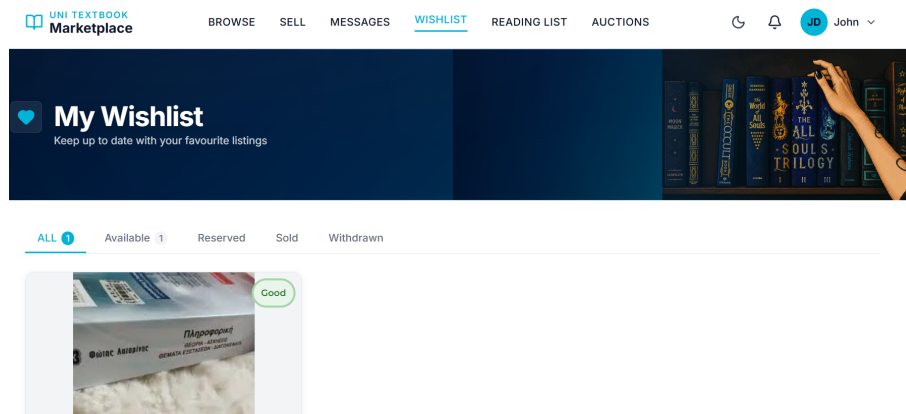


Figure 19: My wishlist

9. Auctions

As well as fixed-price listings, sellers can sell a textbook by auction, and buyers can bid on it live. Everything on the auction page updates in real time, so you always see the latest bid without refreshing.

9.1 Starting an auction (sellers)

Once your listing has been approved, you can turn it into an auction from the listing or from My Listings. The auction then appears with a countdown showing how long is left. Only approved listings can be auctioned, and a listing can only have one auction.

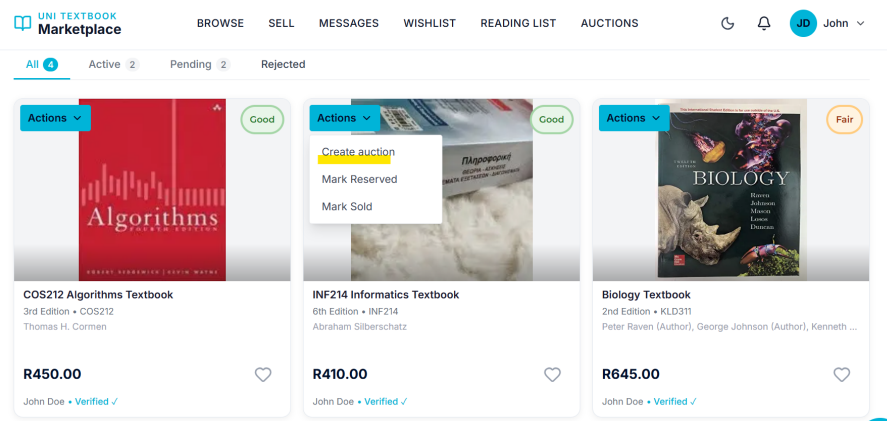


Figure 20: Turning a listing into an auction

9.2 Placing a bid (buyers)

Open an auction to see the current highest bid, the time remaining, and the bid history. To bid, enter an amount and submit it. Some things to keep in mind:

- Each new bid must beat the current highest bid by at least the minimum increment shown on the page.
- You cannot bid on your own auction.
- Bids cannot be withdrawn once placed, so check the amount before you submit.
- If your bid is not accepted, for example because someone else bid a moment earlier, you'll see the reason on screen and can bid again.

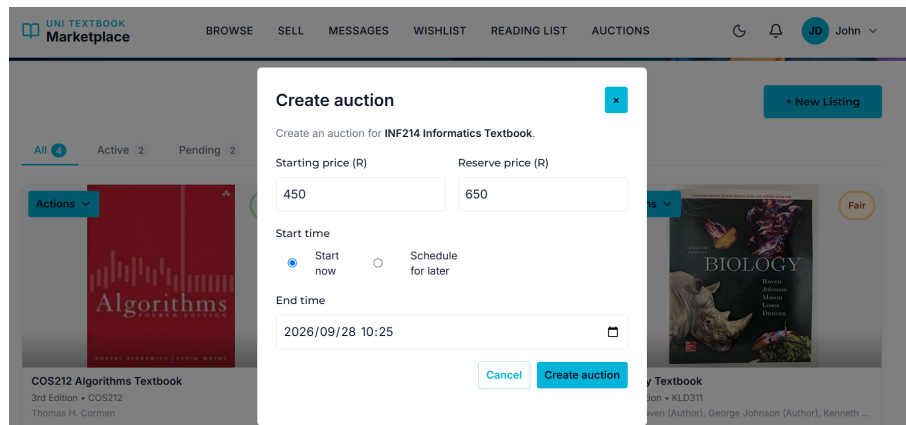


Figure 21: Auction page with live countdown and bid history

9.3 Last-minute bids

To keep the auction fair, a bid placed very close to the end extends the countdown by a short time. This gives everyone a chance to respond, so an auction can't be won by a bid in the final seconds that nobody else had time to answer. You'll see the countdown extend on screen when this happens.

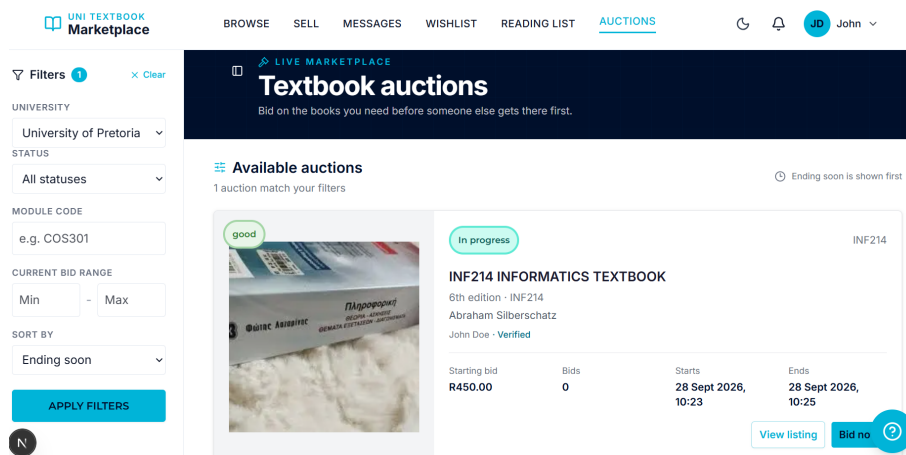


Figure 22: Countdown extended after a last-minute bid

9.4 When an auction ends

Auctions close automatically when the countdown reaches zero. If the seller's reserve price was met, the highest bidder wins. The winner and the seller are both notified, and the listing is marked as **Reserved** so you can arrange the handover through in-app messaging, just like a normal sale. If nobody bid, or the reserve price wasn't reached, the auction ends with no winner.

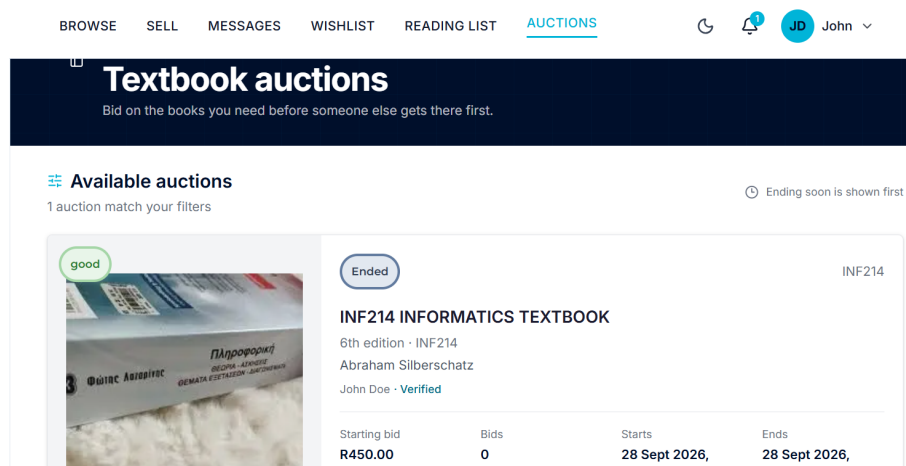


Figure 23: A finished auction

10. Bundle Optimizer

Buying every book you need for a semester from different sellers can mean a lot of separate meetups. The Bundle Optimizer helps you find the best combination. Open it from the navigation bar, then:

1. Search for and select each of the modules you're taking this semester.
2. Click **Find Best Deal**.
3. Review the result.

The results page shows the recommended sellers to buy from, which books to get from each one, the total price, and how many meetups you would need. Next to this, it shows the cheapest possible total if you simply bought each book from its cheapest seller. The two can differ, for example a slightly higher total with fewer meetups, so you can choose whichever suits you better. If no seller has more than one of the books you need, the recommendation is just the cheapest listing for each book.

The optimizer only considers listings that are currently approved and available.

11. Notifications

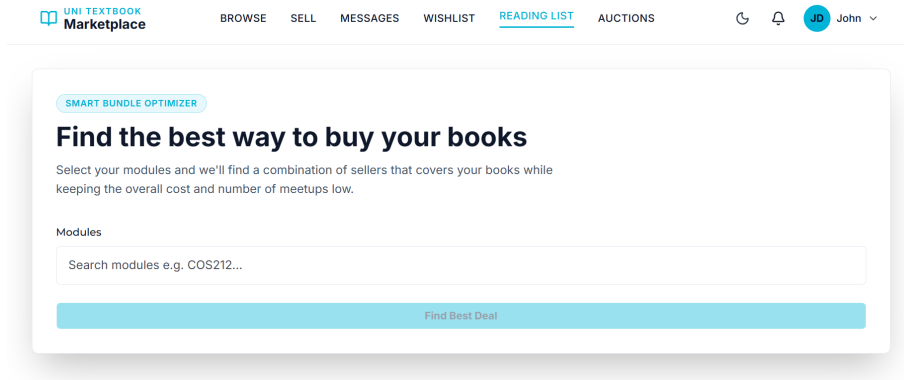


Figure 24: Choosing modules for the Bundle Optimizer

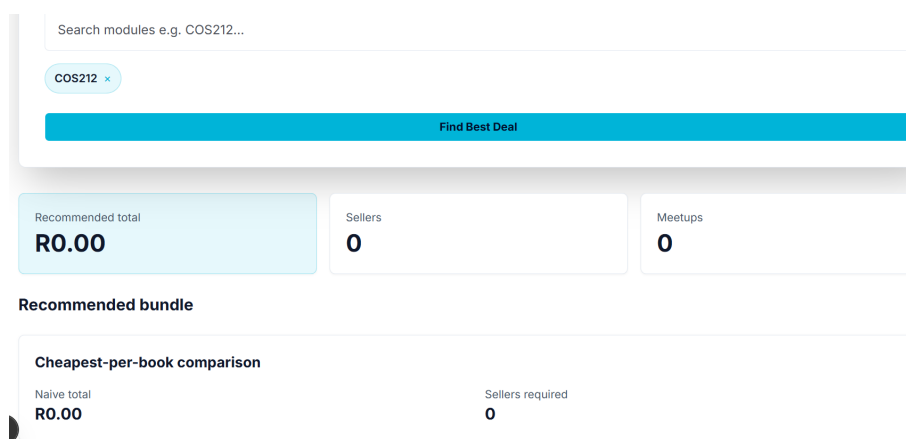


Figure 25: Bundle Optimizer results

The Uni Textbook Marketplace keeps you updated on things that matter to you through in-app notifications. Click the bell icon in the navigation bar for a preview of your latest notifications, or visit the Notifications page for your full history.

You'll receive a notification when:

- Your listing is approved or rejected by an admin
- You receive a new message
- A new listing matches one of your saved searches
- A listing you've wishlisted changes status
- You win an auction, or an auction you started ends
- You submit a report, as a confirmation that it was received
- Your account is suspended, and when an appeal you submitted is decided

Admins are also notified when a seller edits a pending or rejected listing, since it needs to be reviewed again.

Click a notification to go straight to what it's about, or click Mark All Read to clear your unread count.

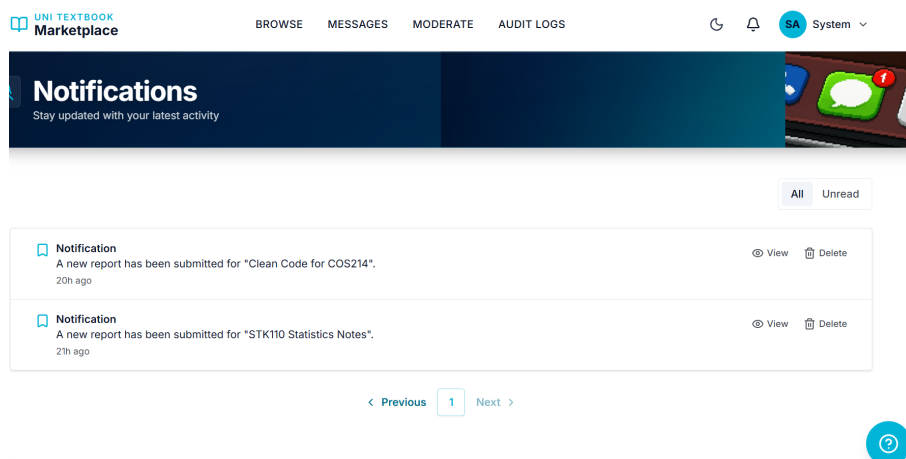


Figure 26: Notifications

12. Profile and Settings

Open your profile from the menu next to your name in the navigation bar. Here you can view your account details, update your profile information, and change your password.

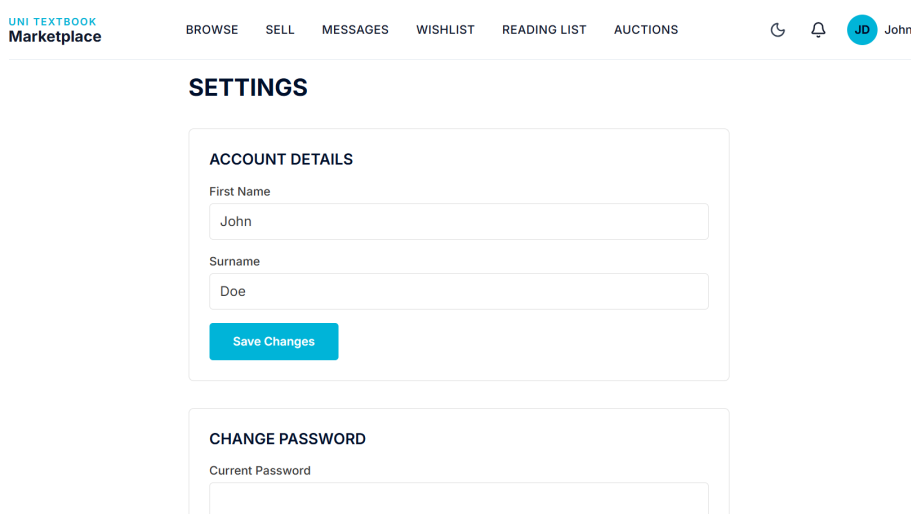


Figure 27: Profile and settings page

13. Account Suspension and Appeals

If your account is suspended for breaking the platform's rules, you'll see a suspension screen instead of the normal app the next time you log in. This screen shows the reason for your suspension, if one was given, and lets you submit an appeal explaining your side.

Once you've submitted an appeal, you'll see a message confirming it's pending review. An admin will look into it and either uphold the suspension or reinstate your account – either way, you'll be notified of the decision.

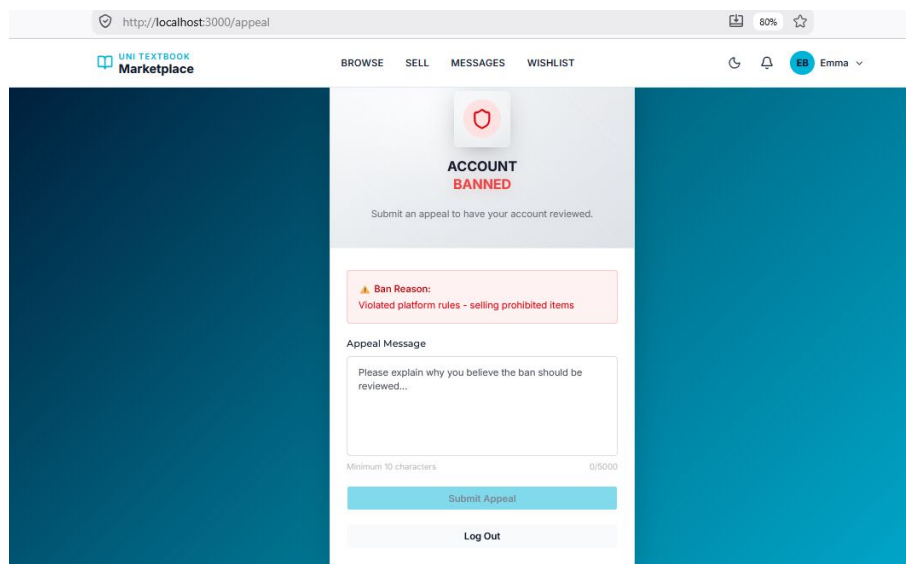


Figure 28: Account suspended screen

14. Moderate

As an admin, you can approve or reject listings from this page.

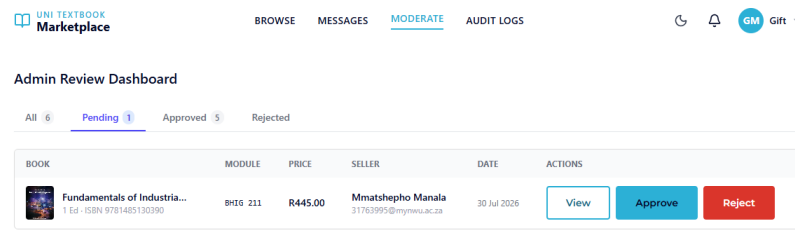


Figure 29: Moderate

15. Report Review

As an admin, you can review listings that students have reported. Each report shows the listing, the reason given, and who reported it. From here, you can dismiss a report if no action is needed, or ban the seller if the listing breaks the rules.

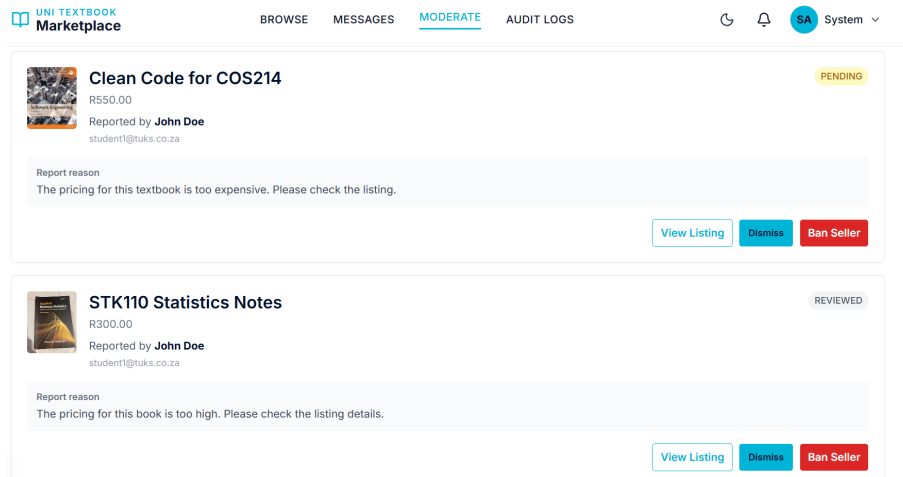


Figure 30: Report review

16. Appeals Review

Suspended students can appeal their ban, and those appeals land here for review. Each appeal shows the student, the reason for their ban, and their appeal message. You can either uphold the ban or reinstate the account, and the student will be notified of your decision either way.

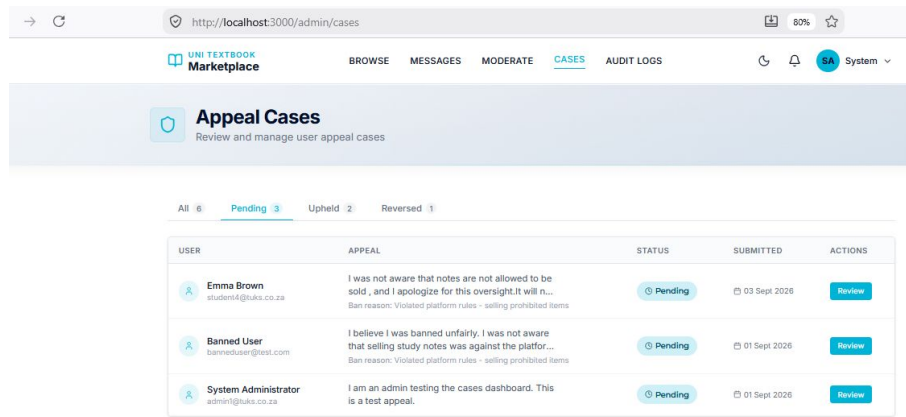


Figure 31: Appeals review

17. Audit log

This page shows all moderation actions performed by admins, including approving or rejecting listings, banning users, and deciding appeals.

UNI TEXTBOOK Marketplace

BROWSE MESSAGES MODERATE AUDIT LOGS

🔔 🔔 GM Gift

Audit logs

Logs of all Admins

Action	Start Date	End Date	Performed by
All	yyyy/mm/dd	yyyy/mm/dd	All

Total Logs: 5

Clear filters

Date	Action	Entity	Performed by	Notes	Reason
31 Jul 2026, 01:08	approve listing	listing	Gift Mohuba u23545527@nuls.co.za	Software Architecture in Practice Textbook	Meets all requirements
31 Jul 2026, 01:08	approve listing	listing	Gift Mohuba u23545527@nuls.co.za	Auditing Notes Textbook	Meets all requirements
30 Jul 2026, 22:16	approve listing	listing	Gift Mohuba u23545527@nuls.co.za	Compiler Textbook	Meets all requirements
30 Jul 2026, 21:25	approve listing	listing	Gift Mohuba u23545527@nuls.co.za	Commercial Law Textbook	Meets all requirements
29 Jul 2026, 16:50	approve listing	listing	Gift Mohuba u23545527@nuls.co.za	Fundamentals of Database Systems Textbook	Meets all requirements

Figure 32: Audit log

Uni Textbook Marketplace

In collaboration with:



2026 NexusDev - University of Pretoria - COS 301 Capstone Project
 This document is version-controlled in the GitHub repository under /docs/Demo_4/User
 Manual.pdf